

PERSONAL TRAINING ROADMAP

6-Month Calisthenics & Strength Plan

Prepared for Rick — a joint-friendly, progressive path from a strong foundation to real calisthenics strength, built alongside steady, sustainable fat loss.

54	127 kg	24	4
AGE (YRS)	STARTING WEIGHT	WEEKS	TRAINING DAYS / WK

Overview & Philosophy

The first priority is building a strong, sustainable base without beating up your joints — then progressively moving toward harder calisthenics.

A good target is **4 training days**, but only **2–3 need to be genuinely hard**. The other sessions are technique, walking, mobility, and conditioning. Adults are generally advised to get at least 150 minutes of moderate activity plus muscle-strengthening work on 2+ days per week, and gradual weight loss tends to be more sustainable than aggressive loss.^[1]

IMPORTANT CAVEAT

Because you're starting at 127 kg, get medical clearance before doing vigorous or high-impact exercise — particularly if you've been relatively inactive or have cardiovascular, joint, diabetes, or other chronic issues.^[2]

The 6-Month Structure

Phase	Weeks	Main Goal
1. Foundation	1–4	Learn movements, build work capacity
2. Base strength	5–8	Increase reps and reduce assistance
3. Strength	9–12	Harder variations, lower reps
4. Progressive strength	13–16	Add resistance/tempo
5. Calisthenics strength	17–20	Stronger push/pull/legs
6. Consolidation	21–24	Maximum sustainable strength + fat loss

The biggest mistake to avoid is jumping straight into "hardcore calisthenics." At your current bodyweight, exercises such as conventional push-ups, dips, and pull-ups are considerably more demanding than they are for a lighter beginner — so we'll use **inclines, assistance, and controlled tempo** instead.

Your Weekly Schedule

Day	Session	Focus
Tuesday	Strength A	Upper body + squat + core
Wednesday	Conditioning / mobility	Walking + mobility + easy core
Saturday	Strength B	Hinge + upper body + legs + core
Sunday	Easy conditioning	Long walk + optional short calisthenics circuit

Two proper strength days separated by several days is a very sensible starting point — ACSM guidance also supports at least two strength sessions per week.^[3]

Phase 1 — Weeks 1–4: Foundation

The objective isn't exhaustion. It's teaching your body to train.

Tuesday — Strength A

Warm-up: 8–10 min easy walking + joint movements.

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Chair squat	3 × 8–12
Incline push-up	3 × 6–12
Band/cable row	3 × 8–12
Glute bridge	3 × 10–15
Standing band shoulder press	2 × 8–12
Dead bug	3 × 6–10/side

Rest 60–120 sec between sets.

Wednesday — Conditioning

30–40 min brisk walking, then easy mobility work:

- Ankle mobility × 10/side
- Hip mobility × 10
- Shoulder circles × 10
- Bird dog × 8/side

Keep this easy.

Saturday — Strength B

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Box/chair squat	3 × 8–12
Incline push-up	3 × 6–12
Band row	3 × 8–12
Romanian deadlift (DB/band)	3 × 8–12
Step-up to low step	2 × 6–10/leg
Farmer carry	3 × 20–40 m
Plank against bench/wall	3 × 20–30 sec

Sunday — Easy Conditioning

40–60 min walk at a comfortable/brisk pace.

Optional — 2 rounds: chair squat × 10, incline push-up × 8, band row × 10, glute bridge × 12.

Don't turn Sunday into another hard workout.

Phase 2 — Weeks 5–8: Base Strength

Now we start making the exercises harder.

Tuesday

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Squat to lower box	3 × 8–12
Incline push-up	3 × 8–12
Band row	4 × 8–12
Romanian deadlift	3 × 10
Split squat holding support	2 × 6–10/leg
Dead bug	3 × 8–12/side

Saturday

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Goblet squat	3 × 8–12
Incline push-up	4 × 6–12
One-arm row	3 × 8–12/side
Glute bridge / hip thrust	3 × 10–15
Step-up	3 × 8/leg
Farmer carry	4 × 30–45 m

Start reducing the height of your push-up surface as you get stronger.

Phase 3 — Weeks 9–12: Strength

We're now transitioning from "exercise" to **strength training**. Use approximately **6–10 good reps** rather than chasing huge rep counts.

Tuesday

Pair	Exercise	Sets × Reps
A1	Goblet squat	4 × 6–10
A2	Incline / bench push-up	4 × 6–10
B1	Band/cable row	4 × 6–10
B2	Romanian deadlift	4 × 6–10
C1	Supported split squat	3 × 6–8/leg
C2	Dead bug	3 × 8/side

Saturday

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Goblet squat	4 × 6–10
Push-up variation	4 × 6–10
One-arm row	4 × 8/side
Hip thrust	3 × 8–12
Step-up	3 × 8/leg
Farmer carry	4 × 40 m

At this point, you should be noticeably stronger.

Phase 4 — Weeks 13–16: Progressive Strength

Start introducing **harder calisthenics variations**.

Tuesday

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Goblet squat	4 × 6–8
Push-up	4 × 5–10
Inverted row	4 × 5–10
Romanian deadlift	4 × 6–8
Split squat	3 × 6–8/leg
Plank	3 × 30–45 sec

Saturday

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Box squat / goblet squat	4 × 6–8
Push-up	4 × 5–10
Inverted row	4 × 6–10
Hip thrust	4 × 8–12
Step-up	3 × 8/leg
Suitcase carry	3 × 30 m/side

GOAL

Start moving from elevated push-ups toward **floor push-ups**. For pulling, an inverted row is much more realistic initially than jumping straight to pull-ups.

Phase 5 — Weeks 17–20: Calisthenics Strength

Now we start explicitly training toward classic calisthenics movements.

Tuesday

Movement	Sets × Reps
Goblet squat	4 × 5–8
Push-up	4 × 5–10
Inverted row	4 × 5–10
Bulgarian split squat	3 × 6–8
Romanian deadlift	3 × 6–8
Plank	3 × 40–60 sec

Saturday

Movement	Sets × Reps
Squat variation	4 × 5–8
Push-up variation	4 × 5–10
Assisted pull-up / pulldown	4 × 5–8
Hip thrust	3 × 8–10
Step-up	3 × 8/leg
Farmer carry	4 × 40–60 m

The assisted pull-up is where you should progress toward your first unassisted pull-up.

Phase 6 — Weeks 21–24: Consolidation

This is your **strength + fat-loss** phase.

Tuesday

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Squat	4 × 5–8
Push-up	4 × 5–10
Pull-up progression	4 × 5–8
Romanian deadlift	3 × 6–8
Split squat	3 × 6/leg
Core	3 sets

Saturday

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Squat variation	4 × 5–8
Push-up	4 × 5–10
Row	4 × 6–10
Hip thrust	3 × 8–10
Step-up	3 × 8/leg
Carry	4 × 40–60 m

Wednesday and Sunday remain predominantly walking.

The Progression Rule

This is the really important part.

Don't arbitrarily add exercises every few weeks. **Progress the exercises you already have.**

Wall push-up → high incline → low incline → bench → floor push-up

Chair squat → bodyweight squat → goblet squat → heavier goblet squat → harder unilateral squat

Band row → higher-resistance band → inverted row → feet further forward → harder row

When you can perform the **top end of the rep range with excellent technique**, increase the difficulty slightly.

Keep roughly **2–3 reps in reserve** most of the time — you should finish a set feeling that you *could* have done a couple more reps. That is much better for your joints and recovery than repeatedly training to failure.

Walking Is a Huge Part of This

For your weight-loss goal, don't rely on calisthenics alone. Walking is exceptionally useful because it gives you additional energy expenditure without the impact of running.

Day	Progression
Wednesday	30 → 45 min
Sunday	40 → 60 min

Then gradually add short walks on Monday/Thursday/Friday as convenient. Eventually, something like **30–45 minutes of walking on most days** would be excellent. Adults are advised to reach at least 150 min/week of moderate activity, and additional activity provides further benefit.^[2]

Don't worry about speed initially. **Consistency beats intensity.**

Weight Loss

Exercise will help, but **your calorie intake will probably determine the majority of your weight loss**. Physical activity and diet work together for weight management.^[4]

A reasonable target is roughly **0.5–1 kg per week**, rather than trying to lose weight as rapidly as possible. CDC guidance describes gradual loss of about 1–2 lb/week as more sustainable.^[1] At 127 kg,

even losing 10% of your starting weight would be a very meaningful first milestone.

What to Track

Body weight: 3–7 mornings/week → use weekly average

Waist: once/week

Push-ups: best clean set

Squat: variation + reps/load

Row/pull-up: variation + reps

Walking: weekly minutes

Your scale will occasionally stall because water weight fluctuates. Look at the **4-week trend**, not individual days.

Recommended Equipment

You don't need a full gym. A very good setup would be:

Sturdy exercise bench/box

Resistance bands

Pair of adjustable dumbbells

Doorway/wall pull-up bar rated for your weight

Exercise mat

The dumbbells aren't "cheating" on calisthenics — they make progressive overload considerably easier while you're carrying 127 kg.

ONE CHANGE TO THE CLASSIC CALISTHENICS PHILOSOPHY

Don't make "pure bodyweight only" a hard rule. At your current weight, losing body fat while building strength creates a fantastic combination: your relative strength improves in *both* directions. A push-up gets easier because you're stronger **and** because you're moving less body mass. That's the combination to aim for over these six months.

*And at 54, better to finish six months with **better knees, stronger legs, a stronger back, significantly better cardiovascular fitness, and 10–20+ kg less bodyweight** than six months of heroic workouts followed by an injury.*

1. CDC — *Steps for Losing Weight*, Healthy Weight and Growth. cdc.gov/healthy-weight-growth/losing-weight
2. CDC — *Adding Physical Activity as an Adult*, Physical Activity Basics. cdc.gov/physical-activity-basics/adding-adults
3. ACSM — *Working with Older Adults? Don't Skimp on Strength Training*. acsm.org/older-adults-strength-training
4. CDC — *Tips for Maintaining Healthy Weight*, Healthy Weight and Growth. cdc.gov/healthy-weight-growth/about/tips-for-balancing-food-activity